Video transcript

The importance of a cybersecurity compliance program

The more people use the internet, the more personal data they provide to organizations. Unfortunately, that data is a valuable commodity to cyberattackers. People expect organizations to protect it.

If a company's business involves internet-connected devices, the company needs established cybersecurity compliance measures. Compliance with these measures is the best defense against attacks.

"At its core, cybersecurity compliance means adhering to standards and regulatory requirements set forth by some agency, law, or authority group."[1] Most cybersecurity and data protection laws pertain to sensitive data. That data includes personally identifiable information, or PII. It also includes financial and protected health information. And the CIA triad's three objectives, confidentiality, integrity, and availability, significantly impact these laws.

Some of the farthest-reaching regulations include the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act, the Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard, and the Federal Educational Rights and Privacy Act. The point of these regulations is to protect people's personal information. HIPAA, for example, ensures that doctors cannot share your personal health information unless you sign a form to approve it. The other mentioned regulations offer similar rules so that sensitive data is not shared freely.

But how do organizations ensure they're compliant? They follow compliance and regulatory frameworks. These frameworks are sets of guidelines and best practices for meeting regulatory requirements. Following the frameworks also improves processes and strengthens security.[2]

To ensure compliance and reduce security breaches, organizations need to design the right policies and procedures. They must also implement proper physical and technical controls, such as stringent password requirements.

Cybersecurity compliance isn't easy and it certainly isn't free. But a breach can cost so much more. And a breach can reduce investor and customer confidence, another serious consequence. In short, cybersecurity compliance can make or break a business, so a strong compliance program is essential for success.

Sources

[1] What Is Cybersecurity Compliance?, *CompTIA*, accessed April 19, 2023.

[2] Compliance and Regulatory Frameworks, *Rapid7*, accessed April 19, 2023.